Live site	https://jacobbaltins.github.io/acreforge/
Code home	GitHub repository jacobbaltins/acreforge (hosted free on GitHub Pages)
Status	Working prototype. No accounts, payments or cloud saving are active.
Name status	AcreForge is a WORKING name and has NOT been trademark-cleared.
Prepared	October 2026

AcreForge

Master Game Plan: make it mine, make it real

Every to-do, checklist, cost, account and decision needed to own, protect, launch, fund and maintain AcreForge, the U.S. land and estate planner. Print it, tick the boxes, write in the blanks.

Important: this is a practical plan prepared by an AI assistant. It is not legal, tax or financial advice. Fees and rules change; verify every price and requirement on the official site before paying. Nothing in it has been filed, registered or purchased on your behalf. Have a licensed attorney and a CPA review the legal and tax steps.

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1. How to use this plan

This document is the whole game plan in one place. It explains what AcreForge is today, what is missing between 'working prototype' and 'real business that I own', and exactly what you do, in order, with costs and time.

- **Part A (sections 2-3):** where things stand and the single master checklist.
- **Part B (4-9):** ownership and protection: name, LLC, domain, copyright, trademark, patent, privacy and terms.
- **Part C (10-13):** keeping it alive: hosting, backups, how to rebuild the site from nothing, security.
- **Part D (14-17):** money: budget, how to fund it, payments, accounts and cloud saving.
- **Part E (18-22):** growth: launch, marketing, roadmap, maintenance, risks.
- **Part F (23-26):** worksheets: accounts, decisions, 30/60/90 plan, glossary.

Three rules

- Your accounts, your name. Every account (domain, GitHub, Stripe, bank) must be registered to YOU or YOUR LLC, never a helper.
- Do not say 'patented', 'patent pending', 'registered trademark' (R) or 'tax-deductible' unless it is literally true.
- Do the cheap, safe things first (backups, domain, LLC). Spend on lawyers and ads only after the name is cleared.

Things only YOU can do: pay, verify identity, sign legal forms, open bank/Stripe accounts, accept terms. Things the assistant can do on request: code changes, site copy, legal-page drafts, regenerating the ZIP/PDFs.

2. Where AcreForge stands today

What exists and works

Area	What you have
Site designer	Infinite 2D canvas in feet; 71 objects (barns, arenas, roads, fences, trees, utilities); layers, snap, rotate, resize, duplicate; isometric 3D massing preview; terrain sculpting; default 80 acres, maximum 1,000.
Maps	U.S. state map (Census TIGER); state terrain viewer (USGS imagery/topo + AWS elevation); optional OpenStreetMap buildings, roads, trees; 3D city buildings; auto-zoom for large acreage.
Parcels	Import KML/GeoJSON parcel boundaries from a county GIS or survey; geodesic acreage; footprint checks.
Building & Lot Builder	Starter homes/barns/shops; 12 library folders; walls, doors, windows; 3D view; place on site plan; DXF export.
Projects	Autosave in the browser; Export/Import JSON; backup and restore button; public export for view-only sites.
Legal pages	About, support/status page, data/privacy notice, disclaimers, calculations document.
Hosting	Free GitHub Pages site; Netlify config included as alternative.

What does NOT exist yet (the gap to a real product)

- No legal owner: no LLC, no registered trademark, no registered copyright.
- No custom domain: the address is jacobbaltins.github.io/acreforge.
- No accounts / cloud saving: projects live only in each browser's local storage. Clearing the browser loses them unless exported.
- No payments: the Stripe webhook file is a stub and has NOT been audited. Do not take money through it.
- No full terms of service / commercial privacy policy reviewed by a lawyer.
- No survey-grade accuracy: all outputs are planning references only (this is a feature of honest positioning, keep the disclaimers).

Honest positioning (keep saying this)

AcreForge is an early-stage planning tool. It is not a survey, engineering package, permit, zoning determination or professional approval. Keeping that language prominent protects you legally and builds trust.

3. THE MASTER CHECKLIST

Work top to bottom. Each box is explained in later sections (section number shown). Date each when done.

Phase 0 - Protect what exists (do this week, ~$0)

[ ] Download a fresh ZIP of the whole project and the site folder; store on 2 places (USB + cloud drive). (sec 11-12)

[ ] Make sure the GitHub account email is yours, has two-factor sign-in, and recovery codes are printed and stored. (sec 10)

[ ] In the app click Backup/Export and save the dated project JSON. (sec 11)

[ ] Print this PDF and the Complete Manual PDF; put them in a folder with passwords/recovery codes.

[ ] Create a dedicated email address for the business (for domain, Stripe, trademark filings). (sec 4)

Phase 1 - Name and ownership (weeks 1-3, ~$100-$900)

[ ] Brainstorm 5 alternative names in case AcreForge is blocked. (sec 5)

[ ] Run clearance searches: USPTO, state registries, Google, app stores, domains, social handles. (sec 5)

[ ] Decide: keep AcreForge or rename. Write the decision in the Decisions Log. (sec 24)

[ ] Consider a one-hour trademark attorney consult for a clearance opinion. (sec 5)

[ ] Form an LLC in your state; get the EIN (free) at irs.gov. (sec 6)

[ ] Sign the IP assignment moving everything you created to the LLC. (sec 6, template A)

[ ] Open a business bank account in the LLC name. (sec 6)

Phase 2 - Domain and brand (weeks 2-4, ~$15-$60/yr)

[ ] Buy the domain in the LLC/your name with privacy, auto-renew, lock, 2FA. (sec 7)

[ ] Point it at the site (GitHub Pages or Netlify) and confirm HTTPS works. (sec 10)

[ ] Set up a business email on the domain (e.g. hello@yourdomain). (sec 7)

[ ] Claim social handles matching the name. (sec 7)

[ ] Update the site's canonical URL, sitemap.xml, robots.txt and footer copyright to the new domain/owner. (sec 10)

Phase 3 - Legal protection (weeks 3-8, ~$200-$2,000)

[ ] Register the copyright for the software (about $45-$65). (sec 8)

[ ] File the trademark once the name is cleared (about $350 per class; use TM until registered). (sec 5)

[ ] Have a lawyer review Terms of Service, Privacy Policy and disclaimers before accepting any money or accounts. (sec 9)

[ ] Decide on patent: probably skip; consult only if something is truly novel. (sec 8)

[ ] Buy basic business insurance quote (general liability / tech E&O). (sec 14)

Phase 4 - Money and payments (weeks 6-12)

[ ] Decide the business model: free, one-time purchase, subscription, or pro/export features. (sec 15)

[ ] Choose funding approach (self-fund, pre-sales, crowdfunding, grants). (sec 15)

[ ] Create the Stripe account in the LLC's name; complete identity verification yourself. (sec 16)

[ ] Use Stripe Payment Links first (no server code); defer custom billing. (sec 16)

[ ] Write refund, cancellation and support policy. (sec 16)

[ ] Talk to a CPA about sales tax, income tax and crowdfunding treatment. (sec 16)

Phase 5 - Accounts and cloud saving (months 3-5)

[ ] Pick a backend (Supabase recommended) and create the account. (sec 17)

[ ] Build sign-in and cloud save behind a feature flag; keep local save working. (sec 17)

[ ] Add data-deletion and export for users; update the privacy policy to match. (sec 17)

[ ] Security test: row-level security, no secrets in browser code. (sec 13, 17)

Phase 6 - Launch and grow (months 4-6)

[ ] Soft launch to 10-20 friendly users; collect feedback. (sec 18)

[ ] Fix top 10 issues; add analytics that respect privacy. (sec 18)

[ ] Public launch post; submit to relevant communities and directories. (sec 18-19)

[ ] Start the monthly maintenance routine. (sec 21)

4. Identity, accounts and email

Everything else hangs on a clean identity. Decide this once and use it everywhere.

- **Legal owner:** you personally for now; the LLC once formed. Use the same exact legal name on every account.
- **Business email:** create a new address (not your personal one) now; later add one on your domain. Put recovery phone numbers and a second email on it.
- **Password manager:** use one (Bitwarden is free). Unique passwords everywhere; never reuse.
- **Two-factor authentication:** turn on for email, GitHub, registrar, bank, Stripe. Prefer an authenticator app or passkey over SMS.
- **Recovery codes:** print them and keep them in a folder with this plan, in a locked place.
- **Who else has access:** if a family member should be able to recover things, write it in the Accounts Worksheet (sec 23) and consider a trusted-contact feature in the password manager.

Accounts you will eventually have

Account	Purpose	Cost	When
GitHub	Holds the code; free hosting via Pages	Free	Have it
Domain registrar	Owns your web address	$10-20/yr	Phase 2
Business email	Contact + filings	Free-$6/mo	Phase 0/2
USPTO.gov (ID.me verified)	Trademark filing	Free to open	Phase 3
copyright.gov (eCO)	Copyright registration	Free to open	Phase 3
Secretary of State	LLC filing	$50-500	Phase 1
IRS (EIN)	Tax ID	Free	Phase 1
Bank	Business account	$0-15/mo	Phase 1
Stripe	Take payments	2.9% + 30c per card sale (verify)	Phase 4
Supabase or Firebase	Accounts + cloud saving	Free tier then ~$25/mo	Phase 5
Analytics (privacy-friendly)	Know if it is used	Free-$9/mo	Phase 6

5. Name clearance and trademark

A brand name is protected by trademark. The risk: 'AcreForge' may already be used by someone else for software or related services, which could force you to rename after you have spent money. Clear it BEFORE buying branding, ads or merchandise.

Step-by-step clearance

[ ] USPTO Trademark Search (tmsearch.uspto.gov): search the exact name, sound-alikes (Acre Forge, Acreforge, AcreForged) and look-alikes.

[ ] Look at classes 9 (downloadable software), 42 (software as a service) and 36/37/35 if you give planning or real-estate-adjacent services.

[ ] Search each state's business-entity database in the states you will operate or live in.

[ ] Google the name with words like app, software, farm, planner, land, equestrian. Check page 3-5 of results too.

[ ] Check Apple App Store, Google Play, GitHub, npm, Product Hunt, Instagram, Facebook, X, YouTube, TikTok, LinkedIn.

[ ] Check the .com, .app, .land, .net, .org domains.

[ ] Write down every possible conflict and its owner, what it sells, and whether it is similar.

[ ] If anything similar exists for software or planning services: switch to a different name. Cheap now, painful later.

If the name is clear

- Use the letters TM next to the name right away; this costs nothing and gives some common-law rights where you use it.
- File a USPTO application: 'use in commerce' (1(a)) once the product is publicly offered, or 'intent to use' (1(b)) before launch. Fee is about $350 per class (verify; USPTO fees change).
- Expect 8-14 months to registration, office actions (questions), and a possible response deadline. Missing a deadline can kill the application.
- Use the (R) symbol ONLY after the USPTO issues a registration.
- Keep evidence of first use: dated screenshots, launch posts, sales records.

Backup names (write yours)

Recommendation: pay for one short attorney consult (often $150-$500) for a clearance opinion before filing. It is the cheapest insurance in the whole plan.

6. Business entity (LLC), bank and IP assignment

An LLC separates you personally from the business, so a lawsuit or debt aimed at the business generally cannot take your house. It also gives a clear owner for the IP, bank account, domain and Stripe account.

Why and when

- Form it before you take money or users. Doing it after is messier.
- Cost: filing fee varies widely by state (roughly $50-$500) plus any annual report or franchise tax. Some states are costly annually; check yours.
- Registered agent: you can be your own if you have a street address in the state; otherwise services cost about $50-$150/yr.
- Single-member LLC is taxed as a sole proprietorship by default (income flows to your personal return). Ask a CPA about S-corp election later.

Steps

[ ] Pick the state (usually where you live). Search the state database to confirm the LLC name is available (it is not the same as a trademark).

[ ] File Articles of Organization on the Secretary of State website; pay the fee.

[ ] Write a short Operating Agreement (even single-member). Templates exist; an attorney can review it.

[ ] Get an EIN free on irs.gov (never pay a site for this).

[ ] Open a business bank account with the Articles, EIN and Operating Agreement; keep business and personal money separate.

[ ] File any required annual report; calendar the due date.

[ ] Sign the IP assignment (Template A, sec 25) from you to the LLC.

Things to avoid

- Do not mix personal and business money; this can weaken the liability protection.
- Do not let any contractor or helper own accounts or code; get a written work-for-hire / assignment from anyone who contributes.

7. Domain, email and social handles

I cannot purchase for you (needs your payment and identity). Do this yourself in about 30 minutes.

[ ] Pick 3-5 candidate domains (.com first; .app or .land are also good). Short, easy to spell, no hyphens.

[ ] Check availability at a reputable registrar (Cloudflare Registrar sells at cost; Namecheap, Porkbun and Squarespace Domains are common).

[ ] Check the name against the trademark search first (sec 5). A domain is NOT a trademark.

[ ] Register in YOUR legal name or the LLC. Registrant email = your business email. Never let a developer be the registrant.

[ ] Turn on WHOIS privacy, auto-renew, registrar lock and 2FA. Register for 2+ years if you can.

[ ] Optionally buy .net/.org and obvious misspellings to protect the brand.

[ ] Set up email on the domain (Google Workspace, Microsoft 365 or a cheaper host); add SPF, DKIM and DMARC records so mail is not spam-filtered.

[ ] Claim social handles with the same name even if you will not use them yet.

Cost

Item	Typical cost
Domain (.com)	$10-$20 per year
Domain (.app/.land)	$15-$40 per year
Email hosting	$0-$7 per user per month
Extra defensive domains	$10-$40 each per year

8. Copyright, patent and what you can protect

Asset	Protection	How	Status
Source code, text, design, original graphics	Copyright (automatic when created)	Optional registration at copyright.gov; needed before you can sue in the U.S.	Not registered
Brand name/logo	Trademark	Clearance then USPTO	Not cleared
Domain	Contract right	Registrar in your name	Not bought
Unique technical method	Patent (rarely worth it)	Patent attorney	Not filed
User data / know-how	Trade secret, contracts	Access control, Terms, NDAs	Local-first helps

Copyright registration

- Register as a 'computer program' at copyright.gov using the Standard Application (about $45-$65; verify).
- Deposit identifying portions of source (first and last 25 pages); trade-secret parts can be redacted.
- AI note: the U.S. Copyright Office protects human authorship and requires disclosure of AI-generated material. Your selection, arrangement, edits, design decisions and original contributions are what you claim. Describe your contribution honestly.
- Put a footer notice: 'Copyright (c) 2026 [Owner or LLC]. All rights reserved.'
- Keep dated versions. CHANGELOG.md in the project is useful evidence.

Open-source and third-party licenses you must honor

Component	Obligation
MapLibre GL JS (bundled in /vendor)	Keep the upstream license notice with the files.
OpenStreetMap data	Show 'Data (c) OpenStreetMap contributors (ODbL)' when used.
USGS imagery / topo	U.S. government data; keep attribution; follow service terms.
AWS Terrain Tiles	Follow the public dataset attribution/terms.
U.S. Census TIGER/Line	Public domain; attribute as good practice.
Google Maps / Zillow links	Reference links only. Do NOT scrape them or copy their data.

Patent reality check

Software patents are expensive ($8,000-$25,000+ all in), slow (2-4 years) and frequently rejected as abstract ideas. For a planning tool, copyright plus trademark plus speed is the realistic strategy. If you believe a specific method is truly new, book a short consult with a registered patent attorney. A provisional application (about $65-$300 filing fee for small entities, plus attorney time) gives 12 months but is not a patent. Never claim 'patented' or 'patent pending' unless an application exists.

9. Terms, privacy and disclaimers

These protect you and your users. Today the site has a data notice and disclaimers that are factual for a prototype. Before accounts or payments they must be upgraded and lawyer-reviewed.

Documents you need before charging money or storing user data

Document	What it covers	When
Terms of Service	Acceptable use, license to use the app, disclaimers (not a survey/engineer), limitation of liability, refunds, governing law	Before payments
Privacy Policy	What data is collected, why, who sees it, retention, deletion, cookies, children, your contact	Before accounts
Refund & cancellation policy	Clear, honest, easy to find	Before payments
Disclaimer banner	Planning only; verify with surveyor, engineer, county	Already present: keep
Data Processing list	Which vendors touch data (Stripe, Supabase, analytics)	Before accounts
Accessibility statement	Honest status and how to report issues	Nice to have

Key principles

- Collect as little as possible. Local-first design is a selling point: 'your plans stay on your device unless you choose to sync'.
- Never put secret keys, passwords or customer lists in browser code or in the public repository.
- Honor deletion requests. Provide an export and a delete-my-account button.
- California (CCPA/CPRA) and other state laws, and GDPR if you serve the EU, may apply once you collect personal data at scale. Ask the lawyer.
- If minors might use it, say the service is for adults 18+.
- Keep the not-a-survey disclaimer near every map, acreage, cost and measurement output.

10. Hosting and publishing the site

Current setup: GitHub Pages

- Live URL: https://jacobbaltins.github.io/acreforge/ (repository jacobbaltins/acreforge).
- Free, HTTPS included, deploys when you push to the publish branch (check Settings > Pages for the branch).
- Static files only: index.html, us-states.js, vendor/, support.html, data-notice.html, robots.txt, sitemap.xml.
- Limits: 1 GB site size, soft 100 GB/month bandwidth. Plenty for now. Commercial use of Pages is allowed for a normal website but no payment processing code on the server side (you will use Stripe-hosted links).

Add your custom domain to GitHub Pages

[ ] Buy the domain (sec 7).

[ ] Repo Settings > Pages > Custom domain: type the domain (e.g. www.yourdomain.com), Save. This creates a CNAME file.

[ ] At the registrar DNS: add a CNAME record www -> jacobbaltins.github.io. For the apex (no www) add the four GitHub A records (185.199.108.153, .109.153, .110.153, .111.153) - verify on docs.github.com.

[ ] Wait for DNS (minutes to 24 hours), then tick 'Enforce HTTPS'.

[ ] Update canonical links, sitemap.xml, robots.txt, Open Graph tags and footer in index.html to the new address.

[ ] Optional: verify the domain in your GitHub account settings so no one can hijack it.

Alternative: Netlify

- A netlify.toml is already included. Drag the folder (not the ZIP) into Netlify Drop, or connect the Git repo.
- No build command. Publish directory = folder with index.html.
- Domain management > Add custom domain; Netlify issues the HTTPS certificate free.
- Netlify also supports server functions, useful later for Stripe webhooks.

Repository hygiene

- Protect the main branch; require a pull request later when others help.
- Never commit secrets (.env files, API keys). Use GitHub secrets or the host's environment settings.
- Enable GitHub secret scanning and Dependabot alerts (free).
- Add a LICENSE decision: leaving it out means 'all rights reserved' by default, which is what you want for a commercial product. Do not add an open-source license by accident.

11. Backups: never lose it

You asked for a way to rebuild if you lose everything. The rule is 3-2-1: 3 copies, on 2 kinds of storage, 1 off-site.

Copy	Where	How often	Done?
1. Live repository	GitHub (jacobbaltins/acreforge)	Every change	[ ]
2. Local folder	This computer: the AcreForge project folder	Every change	[ ]
3. ZIP archive	acreforge.zip (regenerate after each change)	After every release	[ ]
4. External copy	USB drive or encrypted cloud folder	Monthly	[ ]
5. Printed documents	This plan + Complete Manual + Quick Reference	Each new version	[ ]
6. Project data	Export JSON from the app for your own plans	After each session	[ ]

Back up your own project plans

- In the app, use Backup/Restore (or Export). It saves a dated .json file. Keep several dated copies.
- Browser storage is per browser and per device. Clearing site data, using a private window or switching browsers loses it.
- To restore: open the app, click Import/Restore, choose the file. The app shows both save times and warns if the file is older.

Back up the website

[ ] Copy the whole project folder to the external drive.

[ ] Download the repository as a ZIP from GitHub (Code > Download ZIP) once a month.

[ ] Confirm the ZIP opens and index.html is inside.

[ ] Store the Complete Manual PDF with it; it contains rebuild instructions.

Back up the accounts

- Print recovery codes for GitHub, email, registrar, Stripe, bank.
- Keep the password manager emergency kit printed.
- Write the account list (sec 23) without passwords; store passwords only in the manager.

12. Rebuild from scratch (disaster recovery)

If the computer, repository and site are all gone, this is the shortest path back. The Complete Manual PDF has the long version.

Scenario A: you still have a ZIP or folder copy

[ ] Create a new GitHub repository (or reuse jacobbaltins/acreforge).

[ ] Extract the ZIP; upload every file and folder, keeping this structure: index.html, us-states.js, vendor/, support.html, data-notice.html, robots.txt, sitemap.xml, netlify.toml, *.md.

[ ] Repo Settings > Pages > Source: deploy from the main branch, root folder. Wait 1-3 minutes.

[ ] Open the live URL; check the map, designer, builder and Export.

[ ] Re-point the domain if you have one (sec 10).

Scenario B: you only have the printed manuals

Follow the Complete Manual PDF's build section: recreate the files described there, run a local server with `npx serve .`, then publish. This is slower (hours) which is why the ZIP backup matters most.

Scenario C: your account is locked

- Use recovery codes from your printed folder.
- GitHub account recovery: github.com/login > Forgot password; or use a recovery code/passkey.
- Registrar: use the account email; contact support with the LLC documents proving ownership.

Run locally to test any copy

Install Node.js, open PowerShell in the folder and run `npx serve .`, then open the address it prints. Browsers block some features when opening index.html directly from disk, so use the server.

13. Security checklist

- **Never** put API keys, Stripe secret keys, passwords or customer emails in index.html or the repo. Browser code is public.
- Use Stripe Payment Links or Checkout (hosted by Stripe). Never touch card numbers yourself.
- Content Security Policy and other headers: keep the netlify.toml headers; for GitHub Pages add a meta CSP when stable.
- Escape any user text you display (project names, labels) to avoid script injection; review before accounts launch.
- Cloud save: enable row-level security so users can only read their own rows; test by trying to read another user's data.
- Rate limit sign-in and use email verification; offer passkeys later.
- Keep libraries pinned (MapLibre is vendored); review updates quarterly.
- Turn on GitHub 2FA, secret scanning and Dependabot.
- Public export JSON can contain private notes. Review it before publishing.
- Run a security review before enabling payments or accounts (the assistant can do a code-level pass; a human pen test is better when revenue exists).

The ?edit=1 convenience link is NOT security. It only changes the visitor's own local copy.

14. Costs: what this really costs

One-time costs

Item	Low	Typical	Notes
Trademark attorney consult / clearance	$0 (DIY)	$150-$500	Strongly recommended
LLC filing	$50	$100-$500	State dependent; some charge yearly
Operating agreement review	$0 (template)	$100-$400	Optional
Trademark application (1 class)	$350	$350-$700	Two classes doubles it; verify USPTO fees
Copyright registration	$45	$45-$65	Standard application
Terms + Privacy lawyer review	$0 (templates)	$500-$2,500	Before payments
Logo / brand design	$0	$0-$500	After the name is cleared
Domain (first year)	$10	$10-$20	
Patent (optional)	$0 (skip)	$8,000-$25,000+	Usually not worth it
Total realistic launch	**~$500**	**$1,500-$4,500**	Without patent

Recurring costs

Item	Per month	Per year	Notes
Hosting (GitHub Pages/Netlify free)	$0	$0	Free at this size
Domain	-	$10-$20	
Email on domain	$0-$7	$0-$84	
Registered agent	-	$0-$150	If not yourself
LLC annual report/tax	-	$0-$800	State dependent
Password manager	$0	$0-$36	Bitwarden free
Supabase (cloud saving)	$0 then $25	$0-$300	After free tier
Analytics	$0-$9	$0-$108	
Stripe	2.9% + 30c per sale	variable	Verify current rates
Insurance	$25-$100	$300-$1,200	Optional but wise with paying users
Accounting software / CPA	$0-$30	$0-$1,500	
Typical ongoing	**$15-$60**	**$200-$800**	Before any paid ads

Prices are estimates from my general knowledge and from earlier research; they change. Confirm on each official site.

15. Business model and how to fund it

What could people pay for?

Model	How	Pros	Cons
Free + donations	Keep it free; tip link	Easy; no legal burden of sales	Little revenue
One-time Pro unlock	Pay once for export/PDF/DXF/3D	Simple to explain	No recurring income
Subscription	$5-$15/mo for cloud saving, sharing, large acreage, PDF reports	Recurring; pays for servers	Needs accounts, support, billing
Per-project report	Pay per professional PDF/DXF package	Fits occasional users	Lower volume
Pre-sales / founding members	Early supporters buy lifetime or discounted access	Funds development	Must deliver; refund obligations
B2B / teams	Builders, ranches, fairgrounds, realtors	Higher price	Longer sales, support

My recommendation: Free local-first core + paid 'Pro' (cloud saving, sharing, PDF/DXF exports, large acreage) at a low monthly price, with a discounted 'Founding member' annual option. It matches what already exists and what you plan to build.

How to fund the first $2,000-$5,000

Source	Realistic?	Notes
Self-fund the minimum ($500-$1,500)	Yes	Name check, LLC, domain, copyright. Do this first.
Founding-member pre-sales via Stripe link	Yes, once LLC + terms exist	Be honest on what is delivered and when; offer refunds.
Crowdfunding (Kickstarter/GoFundMe/others)	Maybe	Rules differ: GoFundMe donations are generally personal gifts, not tax-deductible, and may be taxable income. Read CAMPAIGN.md and verify current rules.
Friends and family	Yes	Put it in writing (gift vs loan vs equity); ask a CPA/attorney.
Small-business grants / SBA resources	Possible	SBDC (sba.gov/sbdc) gives free advising; grants are competitive.
Agricultural / rural development programs	Possible	Check state ag departments and USDA Rural Development.
Incubators, accelerators, startup competitions	Possible	Local university programs are often free.
Freelance/consulting using the tool	Yes	Paid site plans for ranches and fairgrounds fund development and prove demand.

Simple funding sequence I recommend

- [ ] Month 0-1: spend ~$500-$1,500 yourself on name check, LLC, domain.
- [ ] Month 1-3: build a one-page waitlist and ask 20-50 target users (horse owners, small farms, event venues) what they'd pay.
- [ ] Month 2-4: launch Founding Member pre-sales at a clear price once Terms and a refund policy exist.
- [ ] Month 4+: use revenue to pay for lawyer review, Supabase and tools.
- [ ] Keep every receipt and a simple ledger; the LLC bank account is your record.

Fill-in budget

Use of funds	Amount	Evidence / quote
Name/legal review	$	
LLC and state fees	$	
Trademark + copyright	$	
Domain/email	$	
Terms/Privacy review	$	
Insurance	$	
Cloud/backend	$	
Marketing	$	
Contingency (10-15%)	$	

16. Payments with Stripe (safe path)

The site is static, so the safest first step is Stripe-hosted Payment Links: Stripe handles cards, receipts and security; you only get paid.

Prerequisites (do not skip)

[ ] LLC formed, EIN received, business bank account open.

[ ] Terms of Service, Privacy Policy, refund policy published and lawyer-reviewed.

[ ] Pricing and exactly what the buyer gets are written down and true today (do not sell features that do not exist).

[ ] Stripe account opened by you; identity and bank verification done by you.

Steps

[ ] In Stripe Dashboard > Payment Links, create a product (e.g. 'AcreForge Founding Member').

[ ] Add description, price, tax collection settings (ask CPA; Stripe Tax can help), and a success/redirect page.

[ ] Test with Stripe test mode and test cards first; then switch to live.

[ ] Add the link as a button on the site only after it is live and tested.

[ ] Email receipts: confirm they include your business name and support contact.

[ ] Set up refunds policy in Stripe and on the site.

[ ] Handle access manually at first: after payment, email the buyer a Pro unlock method. Do not build license keys in browser JavaScript; they are not secure.

What 'wire in a Stripe link' means here

Once you give the assistant the live Payment Link URL (a public URL, safe to paste), it can add a button and a clear pricing section. It must NOT receive your Stripe secret keys, passwords or bank details.

The existing webhook stub

The repository has a Stripe webhook source file under netlify/functions. It has not been audited and is not a complete billing system. Do not deploy it for real payments. Real entitlements (who paid) should come from your backend (Supabase) updated by a verified Stripe webhook, with signature checking, idempotency, cancellations, refunds and failed-payment handling. Plan it as part of the accounts project.

Tax and compliance basics

- Sales tax on digital goods/SaaS varies by state; a CPA or Stripe Tax can tell you where you must collect.
- Keep records of every sale; Stripe exports reports.
- Income is taxable; set aside a percentage in the business account.
- 1099-K reporting thresholds change; ask your CPA.

17. Accounts and cloud saving (the big build)

Today every project lives in the browser. Accounts + cloud save turn AcreForge into a product people can rely on across devices.

Recommended architecture

Layer	Choice	Why
Auth	Supabase Auth (email link + Google/Apple optional)	Fast, secure, free tier
Database	Supabase Postgres, one table 'projects' (id, owner, name, json, updated_at)	Simple; row-level security
Files	Supabase Storage for exports/images (later)	Same vendor
Payments link	Stripe webhook -> Supabase function -> 'plan' field on user	Real entitlements
Front end	Keep index.html static; add small sync module behind a flag	Low risk
Fallback	Local storage + export stays working offline	Local-first promise

Alternative: Firebase (Google) works similarly. Supabase is recommended because its data is standard Postgres, so you are not locked in.

Build steps

- [ ] Create the Supabase project in the LLC's account; write the project URL and anon key down (the anon key is public by design; the service key is SECRET).
- [ ] Create the projects table; turn on row-level security so owner = auth.uid().
- [ ] Add sign-in UI (magic link). Add 'Save to cloud' and 'Open from cloud'.
- [ ] Conflict handling: show both timestamps; newest wins with a confirmation (already how Import works).
- [ ] Account page: change email, export all data, delete account.
- [ ] Update the privacy policy and data notice to describe cloud storage and vendors.
- [ ] Test: two browsers, offline then online, deleting an account removes data.
- [ ] Add Stripe entitlement check on the server side (not in browser code).

Timeline and cost

Roughly 2-4 weeks of focused work with the assistant. Cost: $0 on the free tier to start, then about $25/month when users grow.

18. Launch plan

Soft launch (invite-only)

[ ] Pick 10-20 people: horse owners, small-farm families, event venue managers, hobby builders.

[ ] Give them a 3-task test: set acreage, place a barn and fence, export a plan.

[ ] Watch (screen share) where they get stuck. Fix the top 10 things.

[ ] Ask: would you pay? how much? what is missing?

[ ] Collect testimonials with permission.

Pre-launch checks

[ ] Disclaimers visible; support page current; contact email works.

[ ] Mobile and tablet test; Chrome, Edge, Safari, Firefox.

[ ] Performance: large acreage auto-zoom, big projects, slow connection.

[ ] Accessibility pass: keyboard, contrast, labels.

[ ] Analytics privacy-friendly and disclosed.

[ ] Backups current; ZIP regenerated; this PDF reprinted.

Launch day

[ ] Post on your channels and relevant communities (horse forums, homesteading, r/homestead, farm Facebook groups) following each community's rules; never spam.

[ ] Share a 60-second demo video: pick land, drop a barn, see 3D.

[ ] Reply to every comment and email in 24 hours.

[ ] Track sign-ups and feedback in a simple spreadsheet.

19. Marketing and positioning

- **Audience:** rural landowners, horse and livestock owners, small farms, event venues and fairgrounds, hobby builders, realtors showing land potential.
- **Promise:** 'Plan your land before you spend a dollar: lay out barns, arenas, roads and fences on real terrain, in minutes.'
- **Proof:** screenshots of a 80-acre ranch layout, a 3D building, a PDF export.
- **Honesty:** 'Planning tool, not a survey' as a trust feature.
- **Channels:** short demo videos (YouTube/TikTok/Instagram), search-friendly pages ('horse barn layout planner', 'farm layout planner', 'acreage planner'), community posts, local ag extension offices, builders and fence companies as partners.
- **SEO:** title/meta/OG tags and sitemap already added; add a few helpful guide pages and a gallery; submit sitemap in Google Search Console.
- **Email list:** collect addresses only with consent; use a simple provider.
- **Partnerships:** barn builders, fencing and excavation companies, 4-H/FFA, county fairs. Offer free planning for a testimonial.

Message to avoid

- Do not promise zoning, permit, engineering or survey outcomes.
- Do not use another company's name/logo or imply endorsement.
- Do not say 'patented', 'patent pending', registered trademark, or tax-deductible unless true.

20. Product roadmap

Priority	Item	Status	Notes
1	Backup/restore project button	Done	Keep testing
1	Auto-zoom for large acreage	Done	
2	DXF export + 3D building QA	Tested; keep checking	Check in CAD apps
2	In-app PDF export of plans	To do	Print-ready site plan + objects list + disclaimers
3	Polish + SEO	Partly	Gallery, guides, accessibility
3	Stripe Payment Link	Waiting on you	Needs LLC/Terms/link
4	Accounts + cloud saving	To do	Sec 17
4	Sharing links / view-only	To do	Needs cloud
5	Cost estimator improvements	Idea	Regional cost ranges, with disclaimers
5	Templates marketplace	Idea	Ranch, fairgrounds, orchard, homestead
5	Mobile layout	Idea	Responsive touch editing
6	Parcel lookup helpers	Idea	Links to county GIS; never scrape Zillow/Google

Your ideas

21. Maintenance routine

Weekly (15 minutes)

[ ] Check the live site loads and the map works.

[ ] Read support emails; reply.

[ ] Export a backup of the project data you care about.

Monthly (45 minutes)

[ ] Download the repo ZIP; copy to the external drive.

[ ] Review GitHub security alerts.

[ ] Check that USGS, AWS terrain and OpenStreetMap services still load; update attributions if needed.

[ ] Test on phone and a second browser.

[ ] Reconcile the bank account and Stripe payouts.

[ ] Update CHANGELOG.md.

Quarterly

[ ] Review pricing, costs and the budget.

[ ] Update dependencies (MapLibre) after testing.

[ ] Review Terms/Privacy for accuracy; update if features changed.

[ ] Reprint this plan and the Complete Manual.

Yearly - calendar these dates

Item	Due date	Reminder set?
Domain renewal		[ ]
LLC annual report / franchise tax		[ ]
Registered agent renewal		[ ]
Trademark deadlines (office action / Section 8)		[ ]
Insurance renewal		[ ]
Business tax filing		[ ]

22. Risk register

Risk	Impact	Likelihood	What to do
Name conflicts with an existing trademark	High	Medium	Clear first; have backup names; attorney consult
Users treat it as a survey / permit and are harmed	High	Medium	Prominent disclaimers; Terms; insurance; no overclaiming
Losing the site or code	High	Low	3-2-1 backups; rebuild guide
Account hijack (GitHub/registrar/Stripe)	High	Medium	2FA, passkeys, recovery codes, unique passwords
Data service changes or blocks (USGS/AWS/OSM)	Medium	Medium	Fallbacks; attributions; monitor monthly
Data privacy mistakes after accounts launch	High	Medium	Minimal data; RLS; lawyer-reviewed policy
Payment/refund disputes	Medium	Medium	Clear pricing, easy refunds, support email
Taxes handled wrongly	Medium	Medium	CPA; separate bank account
AI-generated code ownership questions	Medium	Low	Document your human authorship; register copyright honestly
Burnout / time	Medium	High	Small steps; 30/60/90 plan; automate backups

23. Accounts worksheet (write it, no passwords)

Store passwords only in the password manager. Store this sheet and recovery codes in a locked place.

Service	Login email / username	2FA type	Recovery codes where	Renewal
Business email				
GitHub				
Domain registrar				
Domain email host				
Hosting (Pages/Netlify)				
Bank				
Stripe				
Supabase/Firebase				
USPTO.gov				
copyright.gov				
State SOS (LLC)				
IRS / EIN letter				
Insurance				
Password manager				
Analytics				

Important documents checklist

[ ] LLC Articles and Operating Agreement

[ ] EIN letter (CP 575)

[ ] Trademark filing receipt

[ ] Copyright certificate

[ ] IP assignment (signed)

[ ] Domain registration receipt

[ ] Insurance policy

[ ] Terms/Privacy final versions with dates

24. Decisions log

Date	Decision	Why	Who

Decisions waiting for you

[ ] Final name (keep AcreForge or rename)?

[ ] Which state for the LLC?

[ ] Free vs Pro vs subscription pricing?

[ ] Founding-member offer: price and what is included?

[ ] Supabase or Firebase?

[ ] Who can help (family/contractors) and under what written terms?

[ ] Funding approach (self, pre-sales, crowdfunding)?

[ ] Launch target date?

25. Templates (fill in; have an attorney review)

Template A - Intellectual property assignment (simple form)

This Assignment is made on _____ (date) by _____ ("Assignor") to _____ LLC, a _____ limited liability company ("Company"). Assignor assigns to Company all right, title and interest worldwide in the software, website, text, graphics, designs, data files, documentation and related materials known as "AcreForge" (or successor name), including all copyrights and any trademark rights and goodwill, created by or for Assignor as of this date and in the future for the Company. Assignor will sign further documents reasonably needed to perfect the assignment. Governing law: State of _____.

Signed: _____ Printed: _____ Company by: _____

Template B - Contributor / contractor agreement points

- Work is 'work made for hire' to the extent allowed, and otherwise assigned to the Company.
- Contributor confirms the work is original or properly licensed and will not paste in code with incompatible licenses.
- Confidentiality of unreleased work.
- No account ownership: all accounts stay in the Company's name.
- Payment amount, schedule and deliverables.

Template C - Support email auto-reply

Thanks for contacting [Name]. We read every message and reply within 2 business days. AcreForge is a planning tool and not a survey, engineering package, permit or professional approval. Please verify site conditions with qualified professionals. - [Your name]

Template D - Founding member offer (draft, do not publish until reviewed)

Founding Members get [list] for [period] at $[price]. You are paying for access to the features listed on this page as of today. Features marked 'planned' have estimated delivery dates and are not guaranteed. Refunds: [policy]. Support: [email].

Template E - Trademark use rules

- Always write the name the same way: AcreForge.
- Use TM until registered; use (R) only after registration.
- Use the name as an adjective: 'the AcreForge planner'.
- Do not use others' marks in the name, domain or ads.

26. 30 / 60 / 90 day plan

Days 1-30: protect and decide

[ ] Backups done (3-2-1).

[ ] Name clearance complete; decision made.

[ ] Attorney consult booked (if name is a go).

[ ] LLC filed; EIN; bank account.

[ ] Domain bought and pointed at the site.

[ ] Copyright registered.

[ ] In-app PDF export built; DXF and 3D rechecked.

Days 31-60: make it real

[ ] Trademark application filed.

[ ] Terms, Privacy and refund policy drafted and reviewed.

[ ] Stripe account approved; Payment Link tested.

[ ] Soft launch with 10-20 users; top fixes shipped.

[ ] Business email and support flow live.

[ ] Insurance quote.

Days 61-90: accounts and growth

[ ] Supabase project and sign-in built behind a flag.

[ ] Cloud save tested; deletion and export working.

[ ] Founding-member offer live.

[ ] Public launch post and demo video.

[ ] First monthly maintenance review and ledger reconciliation.

[ ] Reprint this plan with updates.

What I (the assistant) can do next, on request

- Build in-app PDF export, polish and accessibility fixes.
- Add the Stripe Payment Link button and pricing section once you give the URL.
- Build accounts and cloud saving with Supabase.
- Draft Terms and Privacy for a lawyer to review.
- Regenerate acreforge.zip and all PDFs after any change.
- Run a security review before payments or accounts go live.

What only you can do

- Pay and verify identity everywhere; sign the legal documents.
- Choose the final name and price.
- Talk to the attorney and CPA.
- Run the launch and talk to users.

27. Glossary

Term	Meaning
LLC	Limited liability company: a business entity separate from you.
EIN	Employer Identification Number: the business tax ID from the IRS (free).
Trademark	Protects a brand name/logo that identifies who sells a product.
Copyright	Protects original creative works including software code and text.
Patent	Protects a new, non-obvious invention; costly for software.
USPTO	U.S. Patent and Trademark Office.
DNS / CNAME / A record	Settings that point a domain name to a website host.
Registrar	Company where you buy and manage a domain.
GitHub Pages	Free static-site hosting from a GitHub repository.
Stripe Payment Link	A Stripe-hosted checkout page; no code needed.
Webhook	Message Stripe sends your server when a payment happens.
Row-level security	Database rule so each user can only see their own rows.
Local-first	Data stays on the user's device unless they choose to sync.
KML / GeoJSON	File formats for map shapes such as parcel boundaries.
DXF	CAD file format; used for exporting building plans.
WGS84	Standard latitude/longitude system used by GPS and web maps.
ODbL	Open Database License used by OpenStreetMap; requires attribution.
UDRP	Dispute process for domains that infringe trademarks.
2FA / passkey	Extra sign-in step or device-based login that blocks hackers.

Useful official sites (verify addresses yourself)

- USPTO trademark search: tmsearch.uspto.gov
- Copyright: copyright.gov
- IRS EIN: irs.gov
- SBA / SBDC advisors: sba.gov
- GitHub Pages docs: docs.github.com/pages
- Stripe docs: stripe.com/docs
- Supabase docs: supabase.com/docs

Final reminder: this plan is a guide, not professional advice. When in doubt on legal or tax items, ask the attorney or CPA first.